PHOTOGRAPHY 1 AND 2

SEEING IN BLACK AND WHITE

Take the color away. Find out what is really holding the photo together.

CAMPUS PHOTO WALK TODAY



Michael Kenna, Blackstone Hill Tree, 2010

WHAT IS THE SUBJECT?

- There is a person in this photo.
- There is also a giant shadow.
- Only one of them is the subject.



Fan Ho, Approaching Shadow, 1954

ASK Is the subject the person, or the shadow? Say why.

BLACK AND WHITE IS NOT COLOR REMOVED

Color grabs you

In a color photo your eye goes straight to the brightest color.

Take it away

Now there is nothing to grab. Your eye has to find something else.

What is left

Light, shadow, shape, and texture. That is the real photo.

ASK Name a photo you love. Would it still work with no color?

FIVE THINGS TO LOOK FOR

Every photo you take today should use at least one of these.

01
Light and shadow
Where sun meets shade.

02
Lines
Paths, rails, and edges.

03
Texture
Rough surfaces up close.

04
Empty space
One subject, nothing else.

05
Tones
White to gray to black.

ASK Which of these five is easiest to find on our campus?

A SHADOW CAN BE THE SUBJECT

- Hard sun makes a sharp edge.
- That edge is a shape you can build a photo on.

ON CAMPUS A wall with a diagonal shadow. Shade under an overhang. Leaves lit from behind.



Fan Ho, Approaching Shadow, 1954

FOLLOW THE LINE

- A line leads your eye into the photo.
- Put the line in a corner and let it run.

ON CAMPUS Walkways, stairs, handrails, fences, rows of windows, curbs.



Fan Ho, As Evening Hurries By, 1955

ASK Which line in this photo takes your eye to the person?

GET CLOSE TO A SURFACE

- Side light makes every bump and crack show.
- Flat light makes the same wall look boring.

ON CAMPUS	Concrete, tree bark, peeling paint, cracked sidewalk, gravel, rust.



Aaron Siskind, Jerome, Arizona 21, 1949

FILL THE WHOLE FRAME

- Move in until the object is gone.
- What is left is just shape and tone.

PHOTO 2

Make one frame of pure texture that nobody in class can identify.



Aaron Siskind, Chicago 30, 1949

LEAVE MOST OF IT EMPTY

- One subject. Clean background. Nothing else.
- The empty part makes the subject louder.

ON CAMPUS One branch against the sky. One leaf on pavement. A blank wall.



Michael Kenna, Blackstone Hill Tree, 2010

ASK What would you have to leave out to make this photo work?

USE THE WHOLE RANGE

- Bright whites. Deep blacks. Grays in between.
- Not every photo needs to be high contrast.

ON CAMPUS A sunlit wall right next to a dark doorway. Both in one frame.



Ansel Adams, Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico, 1941

THEN BREAK THE PATTERN

- The same shape over and over makes a pattern.
- Break it once and that break becomes your subject.

ON CAMPUS	Tree trunks, fence posts, window grids, lockers, parking lines.



Ansel Adams, Aspens, Northern New Mexico, 1958

MAKE THE CAMERA SHOW YOU BLACK AND WHITE

01
Press MENU

Find Picture Style on your Canon R50.

02
Choose Monochrome

The screen turns black and white right away.

03
Keep taking RAW

Do not change your file setting. Leave it on RAW.

Now you see tone instead of color while you work. That is the point.

ASK Your screen is black and white now. What do you notice first?

YOUR RAW FILE STILL HAS THE COLOR

On the camera

The screen shows black and white. That is a preview.

Inside the file

The RAW file keeps all of the color information.

In Lightroom

It opens in color. Lightroom ignores the camera preview.

ASK Lightroom opened your photo in color. Did you lose anything?

SETTINGS TO START FROM

Mode	Shutter	Aperture	ISO	Picture Style
Manual	1/250	f8	200	Monochrome

KEEP THE SHUTTER AT 1 OVER 60 OR FASTER

You are hand holding outside. Slower than 1 over 60 and camera shake blurs the frame.

WHAT TO HUNT FOR OUTSIDE

Campus is quiet right now. That is good. Quiet is easier to compose.

A wall cut by a shadow
Hard sun, sharp edge.

Stairs and handrails
Lines and repeating shapes.

Bark and concrete
Rough texture up close.

One leaf on pavement
One subject, clean background.

A bright wall, a dark door
Full range in one frame.

Fences and window grids
Pattern you can break.

ASK Name one spot on campus for the first one. Be specific.

WHEN THE PHOTO IS BORING

Do not walk away. Try these four, in order.

01

Get closer

Then get closer again.

02

Change your height

Kneel down. Hold it up high.

03

Check your edges

Look at all four before you press.

04

Take something out

Move so the clutter leaves the frame.

ASK Your frame is boring. Which one do you try first, and why?

PHOTOGRAPHY 2 GOES FURTHER

Photo 1 is hunting for single frames. You are building a set.

Make them a group

Bring back three frames that belong together. Same light, same idea, or same surface.

One pure abstract

One frame so close that nobody can name what it is.

One almost empty

One frame where most of the picture is nothing at all.

ASK What would make your three frames look like one set?

STOP LOOKING FOR INTERESTING THINGS

START MAKING INTERESTING PHOTOGRAPHS OUT OF ORDINARY THINGS

A concrete wall
can be a great photo.

A staircase
can be a great photo.

It is up to you
not to what is out there.

ASK Tell me the first thing you are going to photograph. Go.